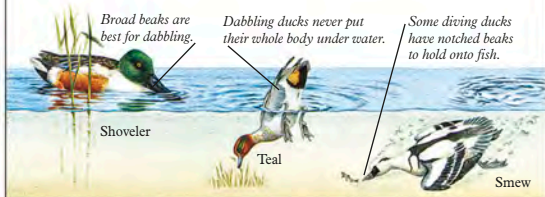


Finding food

Different ducks feed in different ways. Some dabble—they dip their beaks into the water to sieve out tiny plants and animals. Others dive several yards under water to reach weeds, mussels, and insects on the bottom of the lake.



Mallards are about 16 inches (40 cm) tall and live all over the world.



It is easy to tell male and female mallards apart—males have green heads.

Water drips off a duck's back because its feathers are waterproof.



Female mallards can quack louder than males.

Female mallard

Air is trapped between the mallard duck's 12,000 tightly packed feathers to help it float.

These wild mallards may live for up to 29 years, but most only survive for 5-10 years.

Webbed foot

Waterbirds



Black swan



Slavonian grebe



Jacana



Ruddy duck

Ducks molt their flight feathers all at once, so for a few weeks each year they can't fly.